

Dr. Heidegger's Experiment

Nathaniel Hawthorne · 1837

First published: Twice-Told Tales, 1837

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Twice-Told_Tales_(1837)/Dr._Heidegger's_Experiment (revision 11998015), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 8–11 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 1 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Dr. Heidegger's Experiment suggest about youth and folly?
- What does Dr. Heidegger's Experiment suggest about the desire to relive the past?
- What does Dr. Heidegger's Experiment suggest about human nature?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards and frameworks

- **Common Core:** RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4
  Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org
- **Indiana 2023:** 7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1
  Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE

- **Dual Credit (Indiana College Core):** ICC-WC-1.1, ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.7
  Indiana College Core, Written Communication outcomes 1.1–1.7 (CHE guidance); ICC-WC-x IDs are ours
- **AP:** AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN
  AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)
- **Cambridge International:** CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5
  Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)
- **Liber et Libri program outcomes:** LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1
  Liber et Libri program outcome, not an official standard

Primary codes: RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, RL.7.2
Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	Dr. Heidegger's Experiment	1 × 90 min (90 min)	*youth and folly* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Dr. Heidegger's Experiment

Focus: the foolishness of wishing to be young again

Content note (): No significant sensitive content flagged; preview as usual.
Student preview: Nothing in this story needs a special warning.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Old Dr. Heidegger invites four elderly friends, each ruined by vice, to test water from the Fountain of Youth. A withered rose revives in it. The guests drink, grow young, and repeat their old follies: flirting with the widow Wycherly and fighting over her until they knock the vase to the floor. The effect wears off; the rose withers. The doctor has learned his lesson, but the guests resolve to go to Florida to drink from the fountain.

Background: Collected in Twice-Told Tales (1837); Ponce de León's legendary search in Florida is the allusion.

Significance: A tidy moral tale often paired with discussion of whether people learn from experience.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: If you could be ten years older or younger for a day, what would you do differently? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: Nothing in this story needs a special warning.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are exuberant, blossomed, interchange, scandalous, gentlewoman. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years." In this sentence it means: joyously unrestrained. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment would have known. Collected in Twice-Told Tales (1837); Ponce de León's legendary search in Florida is the allusion. Why does this story matter? A tidy moral tale often paired with discussion of whether people learn from experience. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for irony.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "'This rose,' said Dr." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the foolishness of wishing to be young again? I circle "blossomed", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find irony, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of irony. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *'This rose,' said Dr. Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago. It was given me by Sylvia Ward, whose portrait hangs yonder; and I meant to wear it in my bosom at our wedding. Five-and-fifty years it has been treasured between the leaves of this old volume. Now, would you deem it possible that this rose of half a century could ever bloom again?'*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Irony, Symbolism, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Dr. Heidegger's Experiment develops the idea of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this story connect to youth and folly? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the story quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this story suggests about the foolishness of wishing to be young again, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Tonight, read the next story and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
exuberant (adjective)	joyously unrestrained	*They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
blossomed (verb)	developed; grew and flourished	*Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interchange (noun)	an exchange; a giving and receiving	*Inflamed to madness by the coquetry of the girl-widow, who neither granted nor quite withheld her favors, the three rivals began to interchange threatening glances.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scandalous (adjective)	giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation	*As for the Widow Wycherly, tradition tells us that she was a great beauty in her day; but, for a long while past, she had lived in deep seclusion, on account of certain scandalous stories, which had prejudiced the gentry of the town against her.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
gentlewoman (noun)	a woman of good family and manners	*Gascoigne, and a withered gentlewoman, whose name was the Widow Wycherly.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mentioning (verb)	speaking about briefly	*It is a circumstance worth mentioning, that each of these three old gentlemen, Mr.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
selected (verb)	pick out, select, or choose from a number of alternatives	*'Drink, then,' said the doctor, bowing: 'I rejoice that I have so well selected the subjects of my experiment.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
contents (noun)	what is written inside (a letter)	*While the bubbles were yet sparkling on the brim, the doctor's four guests snatched their glasses from the table, and swallowed the contents at a single gulp.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pursuit (noun)	the act of pursuing in an effort to overtake or capture	*Colonel Killigrew had wasted his best years, and his health and substance, in the pursuit of sinful pleasures, which had given birth to a brood of pains, such as the gout, and divers other torments of soul and body.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. If you could be ten years older or younger for a day, what would you do differently?
2. Where does irony appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with youth and folly?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is in the vase? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Water from the Fountain of Youth
2. What does the doctor test first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A dried rose from fifty-five years ago
3. Whom do the three men fight over? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The Widow Wycherly
4. What happens when the vase breaks? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The water spills and the effect fades
5. What do the guests decide to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Travel to Florida to find the fountain
6. Retell the three most important events of "Dr. Heidegger's Experiment" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Old Dr. Heidegger invites four elderly friends, each ruined by vice, to test water from the Fountain of Youth. A withered rose revives in it. The guests drink, grow young, and repeat their old follies: flirting with the widow Wycherly and fighting over her until they knock the vase to the floor. The effect wears off; the rose withers. The doctor has learned his lesson, but the guests resolve to…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Dr. Heidegger's Experiment"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Dr. Heidegger's Experiment" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years." What does "exuberant" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: exuberant: joyously unrestrained.
10. Reread: "Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago." What does "blossomed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: blossomed: developed; grew and flourished.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Dr. Heidegger's Experiment" suggest about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A tidy moral tale often paired with discussion of whether people learn from experience.

2. Find one example of irony in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the symbolism in this story shape what we understand about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
4. In the passage that begins "'This rose,' said Dr.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in "Dr. Heidegger's Experiment", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Old Dr. Heidegger invites four elderly friends, each ruined by vice, to test water from the Fountain of Youth. A withered rose revives in it. The guests drink, grow young, and repeat their old follies: flirting with the widow Wycherly and fighting over her until they knock the vase to the floor.…
6. As the opening story, what does "Dr. Heidegger's Experiment" set up that the rest of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
8. The bell-ringer asked: "If you could be ten years older or younger for a day, what would you do differently?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with youth and folly? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
10. Background: Collected in Twice-Told Tales (1837); Ponce de León's legendary search in Florida is the allusion. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "A tidy moral tale often paired with discussion of whether people learn from experience." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
3. Rewrite one moment of "Dr. Heidegger's Experiment" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
5. Connect this story to the desire to relive the past: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
6. Is the irony in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
7. Compare how “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment” treats the foolishness of wishing to be young again with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Dr. Heidegger's Experiment see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve youth and folly? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
10. What question would you most like to ask Nathaniel Hawthorne about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. What is in the vase?
   A. Rose oil
   B. Water from the Fountain of Youth
   C. Poison
   D. Wine
2. What does the doctor test first?
   A. A butterfly
   B. A dead mouse
   C. His own hand
   D. A dried rose from fifty-five years ago
3. Whom do the three men fight over?
   A. No one
   B. The doctor's niece

C. The Widow Wycherly

D. A maid

4. What happens when the vase breaks?

A. Nothing changes

B. They become babies

C. The doctor dies

D. The water spills and the effect fades

5. What do the guests decide to do?

A. Repent

B. Thank the doctor

C. Travel to Florida to find the fountain

D. Stay young forever

6. In the line “They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years.”, what does “exuberant” most nearly mean?

A. an exchange; a giving and receiving

B. developed; grew and flourished

C. joyously unrestrained

D. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

7. In the line “Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago.”, what does “blossomed” most nearly mean?

A. developed; grew and flourished

B. an exchange; a giving and receiving

C. joyously unrestrained

D. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

Answer key: 1. B (Water from the Fountain of Youth); 2. D (A dried rose from fifty-five years ago); 3. C (The Widow Wycherly); 4. D (The water spills and the effect fades); 5. C (Travel to Florida to find the fountain); 6. C (joyously unrestrained); 7. A (developed; grew and flourished)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this story is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment,” how does Hawthorne show the foolishness of wishing to be young again? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the foolishness of wishing to be young again? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Dr. Heidegger's Experiment develops the idea of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Dr. Heidegger's Experiment suggests about the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's irony and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses irony in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment to complicate the reader's understanding of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Dr. Heidegger's Experiment within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of the foolishness of wishing to be young again responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Dr. Heidegger's Experiment alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of the foolishness of wishing to be young again follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Dr. Heidegger's Experiment and its treatment of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's irony and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Dr. Heidegger's Experiment as evidence for a larger claim about the foolishness of wishing to be young again in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Dr. Heidegger's Experiment as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Dr. Heidegger's Experiment.

SAT-style questions

1. *Inflamed to madness by the coquetry of the girl-widow, who neither granted nor quite withheld her favors, the three rivals began to interchange threatening glances.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “interchange” most nearly mean?

   A. what is written inside (a letter)

   B. an exchange; a giving and receiving

   C. the act of pursuing in an effort to overtake or capture

   D. pick out, select, or choose from a number of alternatives

2. *'This rose,' said Dr. Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago. It was given me by Sylvia Ward, whose portrait hangs yonder; and I meant to wear it in my bosom at our wedding. Five-and-fifty years it has been treasured between the leaves of this old volume. Now, would you deem it possible that this rose of half a century could ever bloom again?'*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”?

   A. A symbol of hidden sin that isolates its wearer

   B. A story told to protect a livelihood

   C. Self-destruction and the urge to do wrong

   D. The foolishness of wishing to be young again

SAT key: 1. B (an exchange; a giving and receiving); 2. D (The foolishness of wishing to be young again)

Whole-book test

Dr. Heidegger's Experiment: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. What is in the vase?
   A. Rose oil
   B. Water from the Fountain of Youth
   C. Poison
   D. Wine
2. What does the doctor test first?
   A. A butterfly
   B. A dead mouse
   C. His own hand
   D. A dried rose from fifty-five years ago
3. Whom do the three men fight over?
   A. No one
   B. The doctor's niece
   C. The Widow Wycherly
   D. A maid
4. What happens when the vase breaks?
   A. Nothing changes
   B. They become babies
   C. The doctor dies
   D. The water spills and the effect fades
5. What do the guests decide to do?
   A. Repent
   B. Thank the doctor
   C. Travel to Florida to find the fountain
   D. Stay young forever
6. In the line “They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years.”, what does “exuberant” most nearly mean?
   A. an exchange; a giving and receiving
   B. developed; grew and flourished
   C. joyously unrestrained
   D. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

7. In the line “Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago.”, what does “blossomed” most nearly mean?
   A. developed; grew and flourished
   B. an exchange; a giving and receiving
   C. joyously unrestrained
   D. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation
8. As used in the story (“They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years.”), what does “exuberant” mean?
   A. joyously unrestrained
   B. a woman of good family and manners
   C. what is written inside (a letter)
   D. an exchange; a giving and receiving
9. As used in the story (“Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago.”), what does “blossomed” mean?
   A. speaking about briefly
   B. developed; grew and flourished
   C. the act of pursuing in an effort to overtake or capture
   D. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation
10. As used in the story (“Inflamed to madness by the coquetry of the girl-widow, who neither granted nor quite withheld her favors, the three rivals began to intercha”), what does “interchange” mean?
    A. pick out, select, or choose from a number of alternatives
    B. joyously unrestrained
    C. an exchange; a giving and receiving
    D. a woman of good family and manners
11. As used in the story (“As for the Widow Wycherly, tradition tells us that she was a great beauty in her day; but, for a long while past, she had lived in deep secl”), what does “scandalous” mean?
    A. what is written inside (a letter)
    B. developed; grew and flourished
    C. speaking about briefly
    D. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation
12. As used in the story (“Gascoigne, and a withered gentlewoman, whose name was the Widow Wycherly.”), what does “gentlewoman” mean?
    A. a woman of good family and manners
    B. the act of pursuing in an effort to overtake or capture
    C. an exchange; a giving and receiving
    D. pick out, select, or choose from a number of alternatives

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how youth and folly develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

2. Explain how the desire to relive the past develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
3. Explain how human nature develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the story's central concerns (youth and folly, the desire to relive the past, human nature) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. B (Water from the Fountain of Youth); 2. D (A dried rose from fifty-five years ago); 3. C (The Widow Wycherly); 4. D (The water spills and the effect fades); 5. C (Travel to Florida to find the fountain); 6. C (joyously unrestrained); 7. A (developed; grew and flourished); 8. A (joyously unrestrained); 9. B (developed; grew and flourished); 10. C (an exchange; a giving and receiving); 11. D (giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation); 12. A (a woman of good family and manners)

Essay assignments

Essay: Youth and folly

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Dr. Heidegger's Experiment teaches about youth and folly. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops youth and folly across Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of youth and folly. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of youth and folly, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Dr. Heidegger's Experiment's treatment of youth and folly in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Name your critical

method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The desire to relive the past

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Dr. Heidegger's Experiment teaches about the desire to relive the past. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops the desire to relive the past across Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the desire to relive the past. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the desire to relive the past, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Dr. Heidegger's Experiment's treatment of the desire to relive the past in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Human nature

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Dr. Heidegger's Experiment teaches about human nature. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops human nature across Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of human nature. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of human nature, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Dr. Heidegger's Experiment's treatment of human nature in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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